Responsible Research Assessment and Metadata Quality for Interoperable Research Infrastructures in Switzerland

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Overview

The **NAIF** project (National Approach for Interoperable Repositories and Findable Research Results) is a swissuniversities-funded collaboration between eight Swiss higher education institutions.

This poster links **Track 1** on responsible indicators and **Track 4** on metadata enrichment.

Core claim: repository interoperability and responsible research assessment rely on the same metadata infrastructure.

Why this matters

Repositories now support	What this requires
Discovery and reuse	Metadata that travel well across systems
Open science services	Structured and interoperable records
Monitoring and evaluation	Transparent, documented, contextual data

Poor metadata weaken **findability**, **interoperability**, and **indicator interpretation** at the same time.

Evidence base

Track	Current work	Main output
Track 1	Workshop with **27 stakeholders** and a planned qualitative survey	Guidance for DORA- and CoARA-aligned indicator use
Track 4	National workshops on metadata priorities	Mappings, reference data, and implementation guidance

DARIAH alignment

DARIAH theme	NAIF contribution
Infrastructures of engagement	Repositories are collaborative infrastructures whose metadata shape access and visibility.
Mapping engagement	Trustworthy indicators need reusable metadata and documented methods.
Policy and governance frameworks	DORA, CoARA, and shared stewardship help turn principles into practice.

Acknowledgments

We thank the NAIF partner institutions, workshop participants from Tracks 1 and 4, and the wider Swiss repository and scientometrics communities for their contributions.

Contact

NAIF Tracks 1 and 4 Responsible research assessment and academic metadata
eth-library.github.io/naif

Partner Institutions

Q1: Why link assessment and metadata?

- Repository metadata now support **evaluation**, **monitoring**, and **policy reporting** as well as discovery.
- Assessment without metadata work risks **misleading indicators**.
- Metadata work without clear use cases risks **underused infrastructure**.

Responsible metrics begin with responsible metadata stewardship.

Q2: Which metadata families create context?

Metadata family	Why it matters across infrastructures
Organisational identifiers	Reliable institution and unit aggregation
Researcher identifiers	Cleaner authorship links across systems
Funding information	Clear links between outputs and grants
Open access status and publication pathways	Interpretable monitoring of dissemination routes

Together these four families provide the **context** needed to interpret outputs reliably across repositories, national services, and international infrastructures.

Q3: What are the emerging lessons?

Signal	Current lesson
Adoption	**24** Swiss institutions have signed DORA; **16** are CoARA signatories
Practice	Principles remain hard to operationalise in daily workflows
Use	Prioritise **organisational monitoring** over individual benchmarking
Quality	Transparent sources and documented methods are essential
Action	ROR, ORCID, funding, and open access metadata are current priorities

Q4: What happens next?

- Map institutional practices, expectations, and tensions through a **qualitative survey**.
- Turn workshop priorities into **practical guidance**, mappings, and curated reference data.
- Build stronger feedback loops between repository teams, assessment experts, and policy actors.
- Feed the results into a **national working-group model** for longer-term coordination.

Conclusion and key takeaways

Evaluation practices and repository infrastructures should not be treated as separate domains. They are parts of the same sociotechnical infrastructure for trustworthy knowledge production, equitable research evaluation, and long-term visibility.

	Takeaway
1	Responsible indicators depend on reusable and trustworthy metadata.
2	Repository interoperability and research assessment must

	Takeaway
	be designed together.
3	Identifiers, funding links, and open access metadata provide essential interpretive context.
4	Shared governance is required to sustain metadata quality across infrastructures.